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Attorneys for Defendants
KATIE PALACIOS and HOPE PROGRAM

SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA

COUNTY OF SAN JOAQUIN

BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI, Plaintiff, v. KATIE PALACIOS, Clinical Director, HOPE Program (Stockton, California), an individual; HOPE PSYCHOTHERAPY, INC., d/b/a HOPE PROGRAM, a California corporation; and DOES 1-10, inclusive, Defendants.	Case No.: STK-CV-UF-2026-0001032 **DECLARATION OF BLAZE VAN DINE IN SUPPORT OF DEFENDANTS KATIE PALACIOS AND HOPE PROGRAM'S REPLY** **Date: July 15, 2026** **Time: 9:00 a.m.** **Dept.: 10A** Complaint Filed: February 10, 2026 Trial Date: TBD

I, BLAZE VAN DINE, declare as follows:

1. I am an attorney duly licensed to practice law in the State of California and before this Court. I am an associate at the law firm of Sims, Lawrence, & Broghammer, attorneys of record for Defendants KATIE PALACIOS and HOPE PROGRAM in this action. This declaration is submitted in support of Defendants' Reply to the Demurrer of Plaintiff's First Amended Complaint. Unless otherwise stated on information and belief, the following facts are personally known to me and if called upon as a witness to testify, I could and would competently do so.

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2. On May 22, 2026, at 9:31 am, my office served Plaintiff with the demurrer and related documents. A true and correct copy of that email is attached hereto as Exhibit A.

3. At 4:16 pm that same day, Plaintiff served Defendants with his opposition to the demurrer, evidentiary objections, declaration, and opposition to request for judicial notice. A true and correct copy of that email is attached hereto as Exhibit B.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of California that the foregoing is true and correct. Executed on July 7, 2026, at Roseville, California.

BLAZE VAN DINE

EXHIBIT A

Outlook

Newanforbi v. Katie Palacios / Demurrer

From Kim Schmitt <kschmitt@sims-law.net>

Date Fri 5/22/2026 9:31 AM

To Brendan Ngwa Nforbi <bnn.cdl@gmail.com>

Cc Blaze Van Dine <blaze@sims-law.net>; Cynthia Lawrence <cynthia@sims-law.net>; June Meinecke <june@sims-law.net>; Amber Krausse <Amber@sims-law.net>

4 attachments (5 MB)

Demurrer-(NEWpal) (052226)).pdf; Demurrer-Decl (NEWpal) (052226)).pdf; Demurrer-RJN (NEWpal) (052226)).pdf; Demurrer-PO (NEWpal) (052226)).pdf;

Mr. Newanforbi, attached please find the Demurrer on behalf of Katie Palacios and HOPE Program. San Joaquin County requires we file the Demurrer, provide them with several dates to hear the motion. The court will then return our Demurrer with a date for the hearing when the court is available. Once we have the actual scheduled date, we will re-serve you with the Demurrer paperwork

DEFENDANTS KATIE PALACIOS AND HOPE PROGRAM'S NOTICE OF DEMURRER AND DEMURRER TO PLAINTIFF'S FIRST AMENDED COMPLAINT; MEMORANDUM OF POINTS AND AUTHORITIES IN SUPPORT

DECLARATION OF BLAZE VAN DINE IN SUPPORT OF DEFENDANTS KATIE PALACIOS AND HOPE PROGRAM'S DEMURRER TO PLAINTIFF'S FIRST AMENDED COMPLAINT

DEFENDANTS KATIE PALACIOS AND HOPE PROGRAM'S REQUEST FOR JUDICIAL NOTICE IN SUPPORT OF DEMURRER TO PLAINTIFF'S FIRST AMENDED COMPLAINT

[PROPOSED] ORDER ON DEFENDANTS KATIE PALACIOS AND HOPE PROGRAM'S DEMURRER TO PLAINTIFF'S FIRST AMENDED COMPLAINT

Kim Schmitt
Legal Secretary

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SLB
Sims, Lawrence & Broghammer
CIVIL LITIGATION DEFENSE

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Confidentiality Notice
This electronic message transmission contains information from the law firm of Sims, Lawrence & Broghammer which may be confidential or protected by the attorney-client privilege and/or the work product doctrine. If you are not the intended recipient, be aware that any disclosure, copying, distribution or use of the content of this information is prohibited. If you have received this communication in error, please notify us immediately by email or phone at 916 797 8881 and delete the original message. IRS NOTICE: Sims, Lawrence & Broghammer does not give tax advice. Nothing in this email should be construed to indicate otherwise.

EXHIBIT B

Outlook

Newanforbi v. Palacios – Opposition to Demurrer and Supporting Papers

From Brendan Ngwa Nforbi <bnn.cdl@gmail.com>
Date Fri 5/22/2026 4:16 PM
To Blaze Van Dine <blaze@sims-law.net>
Cc Cynthia Lawrence <cynthia@sims-law.net>; June Meinecke <june@sims-law.net>; Kim Schmitt <kschmitt@sims-law.net>; Amber Krausse <Amber@sims-law.net>; SLB eservice <SLB-eservice@sims-law.net>

4 attachments (24 MB)

Opposition to Demurrer Pal.pdf; Evidentiary Pal Objections to Defendants RJN.pdf; Declaration Pal ISO Opposition.pdf; RJN Pal ISO Opposition.pdf;

Counsel,

Please be advised that the Court has confirmed July 15, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. as the hearing date on Defendants' demurrer in Newanforbi v. Palacios, Case No. STK-CV-UF-2026-0001032.

The following documents were filed with the Court today, May 22, 2026, and are being served on you and your designated e-service email address in connection with that hearing:

- Plaintiff's Opposition to Demurrer to First Amended Complaint
- Declaration of Brendan Ngehsi Newanforbi in Support of Opposition to Demurrer
- Plaintiff's Request for Judicial Notice in Support of Opposition to Demurrer
- Plaintiff's Evidentiary Objections to Defendants' Request for Judicial Notice

This email constitutes service of conformed copies of the above-listed documents on Defendants Katie Palacios and HOPE Psychotherapy, Inc. dba HOPE Program, through their counsel of record, at the designated e-service address.

Regards,

Brendan Ngehsi Newanforbi

PROOF OF SERVICE

I, Kim Schmitt, certify and declare as follows:

I am over the age of 18 years, and not a party to this action. My business address is 1478 Stone Point Drive, Suite 450, Roseville, CA 95661. My business email is: kschmitt@sims-law.net. I am employed in the County of Placer where this service occurs.

On the date set forth below, following ordinary business practice, I served a true copy of the foregoing document(s) described as:

DECLARATION OF BLAZE VAN DINE IN SUPPORT OF DEFENDANTS KATIE PALACIOS AND HOPE PROGRAM'S REPLY

☐ (BY MAIL) I am readily familiar with my employer's normal business practice for collection and processing of correspondence for mailing with the U.S. Postal Service. Correspondence so collected and processed is deposited with the U.S. Postal Service that same day in the ordinary course of business. I placed for deposit in the United States Postal Service in a sealed envelope, with postage fully prepaid, to the addressee(s) below.

☐ (BY PERSONAL SERVICE) I personally delivered the above document(s) by hand between 9:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m. to the office of the addressee(s) below.

☐ (BY OVERNIGHT DELIVERY) I deposited in a box or other facility regularly maintained by Federal Express an express service carrier, or delivered to a courier or driver authorized by said express service carrier to receive such envelope(s) to be delivered by overnight delivery, with delivery fees paid or provided for, addressed to the person(s) on whom it is to be served below.

☒ (BY ELECTRONIC SERVICE) I transmitted via electronic service through electronic mail to the offices of the addressee(s) below as stated on the attached service list on this date before 5:00 p.m.

SEE ATTACHED SERVICE LIST

☒ (State) I certify and declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of California that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed on: July 7, 2026

Kim Schmitt

SERVICE LIST

Brendan Ngehsi Newanforbi Plaintiff, in Pro Per 1455 Cat Tail Drive Stockton, CA 95204 (209) 801-4442 E: bnn.cdl@gmail.com	**PLAINTIFF, IN PER**